

Chadwick (Chad) Kraus

Network IT Specialist · QA Ops · Technical Support Lead · AI Tooling & Workflow Optimization

(512) 650-7633 chadkraus87@gmail.com Austin, TX (Remote) linkedin.com/in/chadwick-kraus

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Versatile technical professional with 5+ years of experience spanning network and IT support, AV systems, QA operations, AI tooling, and cross-functional team enablement in SaaS and networked device ecosystems. Currently serving as Network IT Specialist at Rockbot with an expanded scope including Tier 2/3 escalation ownership, QA Ops participation, Bug Triage leadership, and end-to-end pilot account management. Hands-on experience building AI agents and applications using Claude Code, designing intelligent triage workflows, and applying AI tooling to improve support operations and process scalability. Known for identifying operational gaps, building proactive workflows that reduce customer impact before issues escalate, and bridging the gap between technical teams and non-technical stakeholders.

CORE SKILLS & EXPERTISE

AI Tooling & Ops	AI agent & application development (Claude Code) · intelligent triage · workflow automation · Zendesk AI Co-Pilot · agent assist · support data hygiene · process scalability
Technical Support	Tier 2/3 escalation ownership · root cause analysis · Console log analysis · API & SaaS diagnostics · hardware & network troubleshooting
AV & Device Systems	Smart Amp configuration & troubleshooting · Rockbot Players · Sonos · BrightSign · Amazon Signage Stick · Tizen 7.0 · PoE · digital signage · AV signal flow
Networking	TCP/IP · VLANs · firewall configuration · enterprise network environments · connectivity diagnostics
QA & Testing	QA Ops · product testing cycles · defect verification · bug triage leadership · regression validation · risk analysis
Identity & Auth	SSO · SAML · MFA · OAuth · Okta · Azure AD / Microsoft Entra · API integrations
Operations	SOP & playbook development · proactive workflow design · pilot account management · support reporting · Zendesk administration
Communication	Cross-functional liaison · technical ↔ non-technical translation · stakeholder reporting · team mentorship · customer success & CRM
Development	JavaScript · HTML5/CSS3 · Node.js · React · REST APIs · MySQL · MongoDB · Git · Claude Code

WORK EXPERIENCE

Network IT Specialist

April 2026 – Present

Rockbot · Austin, TX (Remote)

- Serve as one of the primary technical owners for pilot and trial execution across SMB, Enterprise, and SLA customers — leading white-glove deployment readiness, installation calls, and post-launch postmortem initiatives to identify root causes and prevent recurrence.
- Own Tier 2/3 escalations across networking, firewall configuration, AV hardware (Smart Amp, Sonos, BrightSign, Tizen), APIs, identity systems (SSO/SAML/Entra), and SaaS platform behavior — full accountability from triage through resolution.
- Provide daily AV support for Rockbot Smart Amps, diagnosing issues across audio signal flow, speaker detection, firmware behavior, and network connectivity to ensure consistent audio delivery across customer environments.
- Active QA Ops team member — completing product testing cycles, verifying defects with Engineering, and maintaining QA process continuity in the absence of a dedicated QA Director.
- Chair weekly Bug Triage meeting; produce Bug Triage notes and Bug Highlights reports for cross-functional leadership.
- Build AI agents and applications using Claude Code to automate support workflows, improve intelligent triage, and reduce manual overhead — applying a practitioner's perspective to AI tooling decisions and support operations scalability.

- Developing Zendesk AI Co-Pilot capabilities with focus on intelligent triage, agent assist workflows, self-service improvements, and support data hygiene.
- **Proactive SD Card Health Monitoring workflow:** identified a gap where Player SD card errors were logged but unaddressed; built a daily triage process to detect errors, classify root cause (failure vs. ejection), determine replacement eligibility, and proactively contact affected customers — offering a courtesy replacement or remote provisioning files. Converts a reactive support scenario into a proactive customer experience touchpoint.
- **Protected a significant enterprise deployment** by identifying a firmware compatibility issue mid-rollout across a large multi-location account and driving full-fleet Engineering remediation before customer impact.
- **Ensured go-live for a multi-location credit union deployment** by identifying and resolving a hardware firmware defect during installation; fix released company-wide to prevent recurrence.
- Primary liaison between Engineering/QA and all customer-facing teams — translating defects into actionable updates and customer-facing communications.
- Produce monthly Support-identified bug reports; authored deployment documentation and escalation playbooks adopted across the Support organization.

Senior Technical Support & Escalation Specialist

September 2022 – April 2026

Rockbot · Austin, TX (Remote)

- Led technical ownership of high-severity escalations involving hardware, networks, APIs, identity systems, and SaaS platform behavior; conducted deep root cause analysis collaborating with QA and Engineering.
- Provided escalation support across AV and networked device portfolio — Rockbot Players, Smart Amps, Sonos, Amazon Signage Stick, and Tizen — diagnosing issues across networks, AV signal flow, and device behaviors.
- Identified critical customer-impacting bugs enabling proactive Engineering fixes that reduced ticket volume; produced weekly Bug Triage notes and monthly Support-identified bug reports across four cross-functional teams.
- Served as cross-functional liaison translating technical issues into actionable updates for non-technical stakeholders; mentored technical specialists and developed SOPs and training materials.

Technical Support Specialist

April 2021 – January 2022

8am (formerly AffiniPay) · Austin, TX

- Provided escalation support for a financial SaaS platform handling API integrations, payment workflows, and transaction errors; led troubleshooting across web, network, and integration layers.
- Guided clients through PCI compliance, secure usage practices, and fraud mitigation; maintained 99%+ CSAT.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Full-Stack Web Development Certificate

August 2023

University of Texas at Austin

JavaScript · HTML5 · CSS3 · Node.js · Express.js · MySQL · MongoDB · React · Git · REST APIs

Google IT Support Specialist Professional Certificate

October 2023

Network Engineering · System Administration (Windows, Linux, Mac) · Network Security